

Dusty sky

Huge clouds of dust were thrown up into the sky when the asteroid hit the ground. They blocked out the sunlight, which turned the planet cold and dark for many years.

Dying plants

Hot debris from the asteroid started fires that destroyed plants. They could not grow again because the dust in the sky blocked out the sunlight they needed to survive.

Making an impact

It is thought that the asteroid that hit the Earth was 6 miles (10 km) across! The crater caused by the impact is 110 miles (180 km) wide. It was discovered in 1990, in a town called Chicxulub, in Mexico.

